

COMPARING RATES OF TURNAROUND TIME, ADHERENCE, AND PERSISTENCE AMONG PATIENTS AT VANDERBILT SPECIALTY PHARMACY COMPARED TO EXTERNAL SPECIALTY PHARMACIES

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PURPOSE

Compare rates of turnaround time (TAT), secondary adherence, and persistence between patients filling specialty medication with Vanderbilt Specialty Pharmacy, an integrated health-system specialty pharmacy (HSSP) to those using external specialty pharmacies (non-HSSP).

METHODS

Study Design	Retrospective cohort study
Setting	- Vanderbilt Health System Oncology, Inflammatory (Rheumatoid Arthritis [RA], Inflammatory Bowel Disease [IBD], and Dermatology), or Multiple Sclerosis (MS) clinics - Filling pharmacy was categorized into HSSP, non-HSSP, and never filled - For adherence calculations, patients with $\geq 50\%$ of fills at an HSSP were classified as HSSP patient
Sample	Inclusion Criteria: Patients with a specialty medication prescription between June 1, 2021, to May 31, 2022 Exclusion Criteria: Specialty medication fill within 180 days of the index prescription or used alternative filling methods (e.g., patient assistance programs). - TAT: prescribed medication was administered by a prescriber, or the medication required an intravenous loading dose. - Adherence: Patients with <3 fills
Analysis	- Wilcoxon rank sum test: comparisons of turnaround time and adherence outcomes - Pearson's Chi squared test: persistence

Turnaround Time

Time from a specialty medication prescription to the first filled claim
Lengthy TAT >14 days

Adherence & Persistence

Computed at 12 months from prescription
Adherence: Proportion of days covered (PDC)
Persistence: Lack of a 60+ day gap

CONCLUSION

Patients who filled with the HSSP had higher adherence.

Patients with inflammatory conditions who filled with the HSSP had shorter turnaround time and higher rates of persistence compared to patients with inflammatory conditions who filled at non-HSSP.

Patients with MS who filled with the HSSP had higher adherence.

RESULTS

Table 1. Baseline Characteristics

Characteristic n (%)	Total N=1792	HSSP n=897	Non-HSSP n=470	Never Filled n=425
Age- median (IQR)	58 (44 - 69)	60 (46 - 70)	53 (41 - 61)	62 (46 - 71)
Gender, female	966 (54%)	469 (52%)	270 (57%)	227 (53%)
Race, White	1456 (85%)	714 (84%)	383 (85%)	359 (90%)
Insurance Type				
Commercial	912 (53%)	400 (46%)	323 (71%)	189 (47%)
Government/ Other	823 (47%)	471 (54%)	135 (30%)	217 (53%)
Clinical Area				
Oncology	1001 (56%)	584 (65%)	233 (50%)	184 (43%)
Inflammatory	623 (35%)	246 (27%)	188 (40%)	189 (45%)
Multiple Sclerosis	168 (9%)	67 (7%)	49 (10%)	52 (12%)

Figure 2. Top Reasons for Lengthy (>14 Days) Turnaround Time

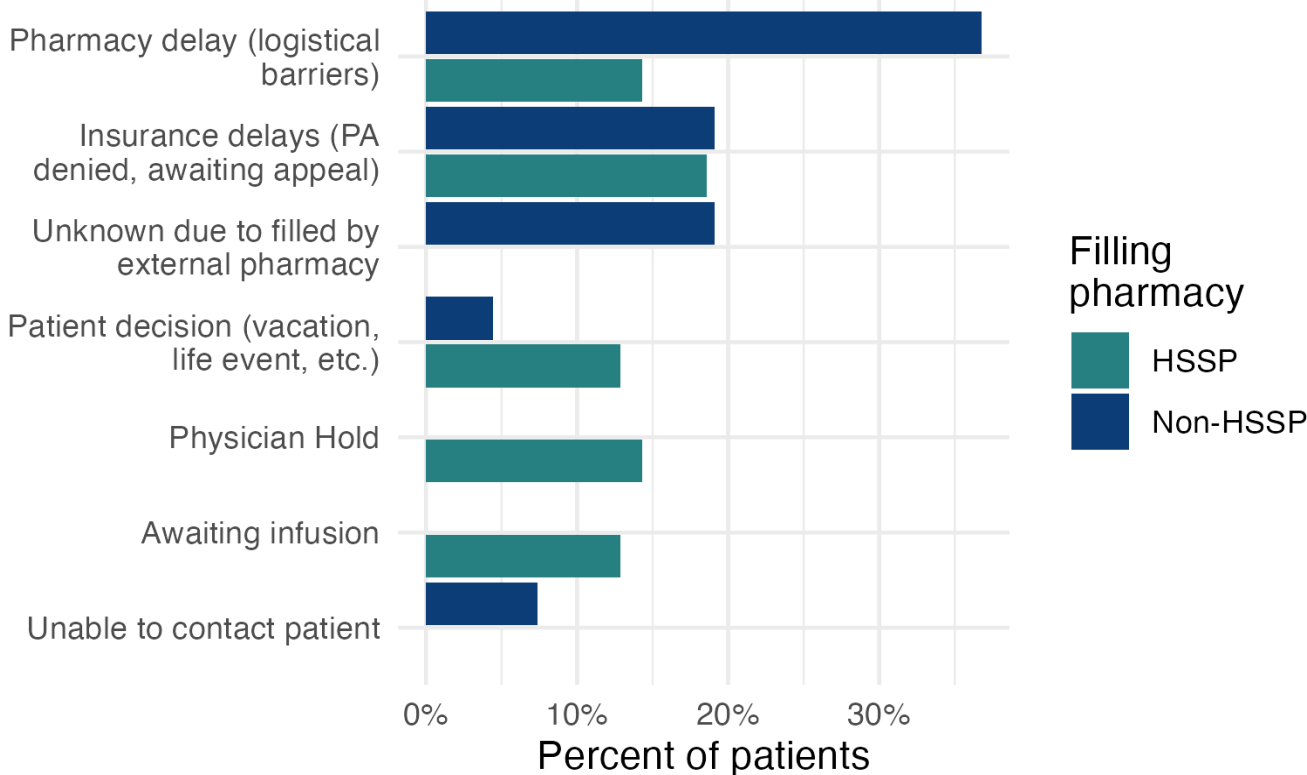


Figure 1. Median Turnaround Time (Days)

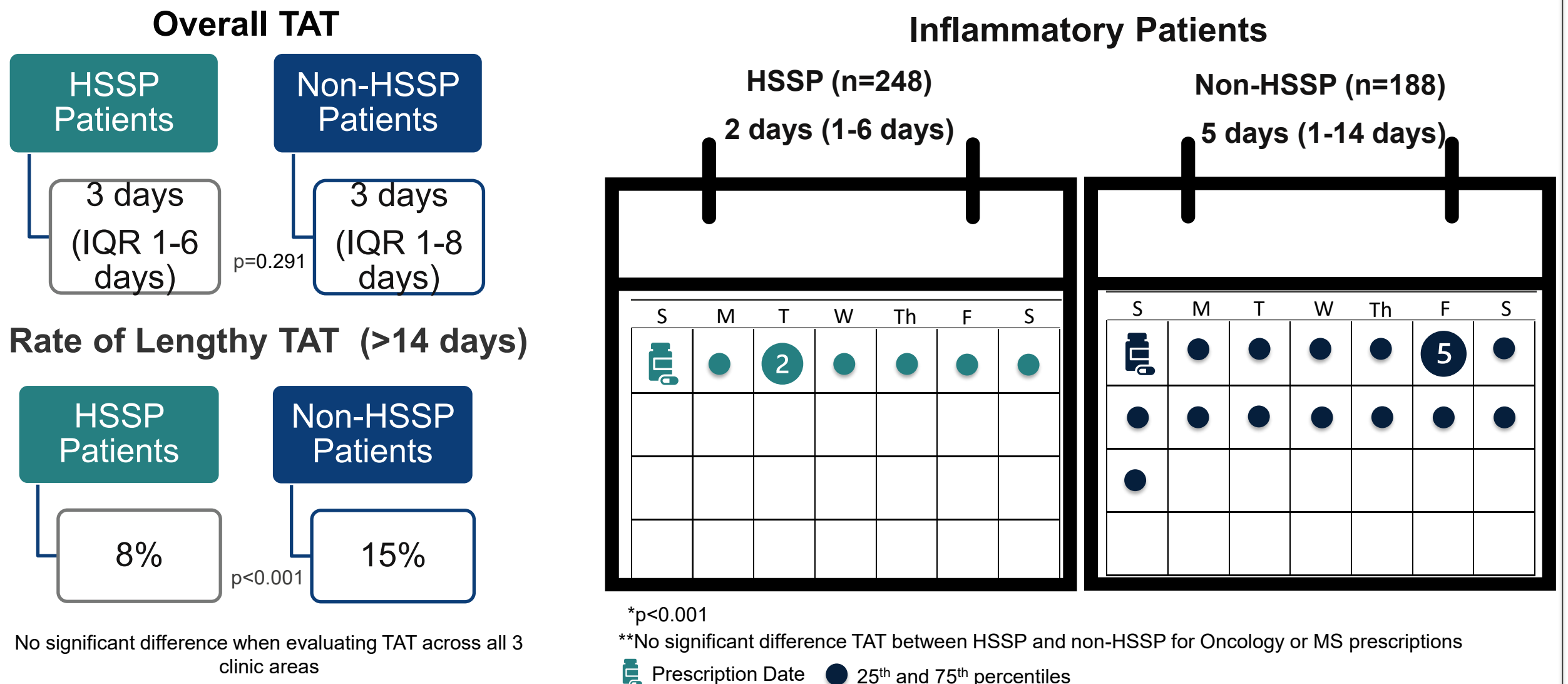


Table 2. Adherence (PDC)

Characteristic	Pharmacy		
	HSSP N = 626	Non-HSSP N = 473	p-value
PDC (Median, [IQR])	0.96 (0.84 - 1.00)	0.94 (0.79 - 1.00)	0.03

One-Year PDC

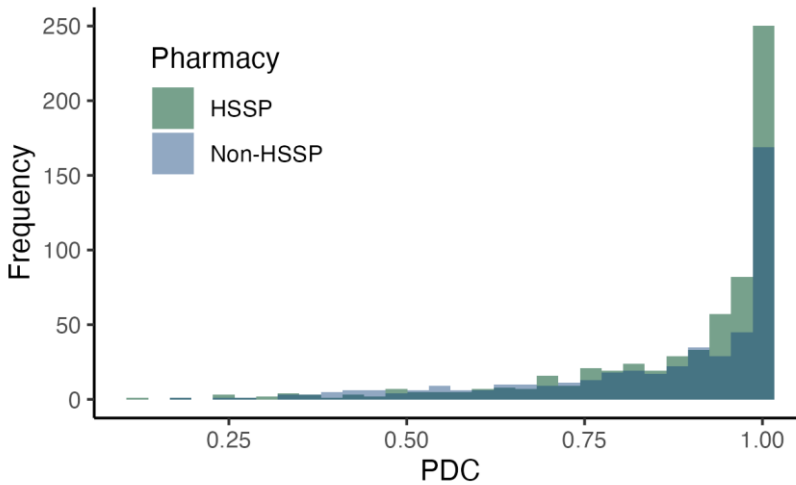


Table 3. Persistence

Characteristic	Pharmacy		
	HSSP N = 627	Non-HSSP N = 472	p-value
Non-Persistent	423 (68%)	343 (73%)	0.063

Inflammatory Patient Persistence

